

G raphics Professional s

Canon i905D

Expensive hardware

The Canon i905D is a slightly slower than Canon's other models, such as the Canon i455 and the Canon i560. Text printing somehow doesn't go well with the Canon i905D, but it's fast when it comes to printing photographs.

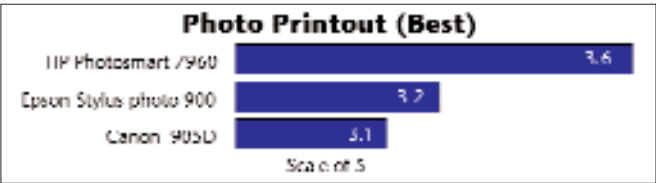
The print quality of text output was ordinary, going by the standards set by the Canon i560 and Canon i455. There was some smudging and jaggedness near the edges of characters. But when it came to images, each minute detail was reproduced with near-perfect quality. The tonal balance was excellent, except for the yellow spectrum. Even then, the photos aren't as good as those printed by the HP Photosmart 7960. A colour printout will set you back by Rs 4, and a text page will cost you Rs 2.

The Canon i905D can be hooked to a PC via USB. It uses the six-individual-cartridge system, which makes for savings on ink as well as great photo reproduction. You can connect a digicam

directly to the Canon i950D without the need for an intervening PC. The driver has several tweaking options, such as noise reduction, image enhancing, etc. The ink-level monitor is rather inaccurate.

The printer is compact. The external paper trays folds for a clean look, but are flimsy and more cosmetic than functional. The control panel comprises an LCD display with a jog dial. The display shows all menus, from where one can choose from almost all options, such as paper size, ink mode, etc. It also comes with a 5-in-1 memory card reader. Other accessories such as CD-face printing adapter and a 4x6 photo printing adapter come bundled.

At Rs 21,995, the Canon i905D is an expensive piece of hardware. Exclusivity of features makes it stand out from the crowd, but the output quality does not justify the price tag.



- + Feature-rich
- Quite expensive as a package

Canon i905D	B
Performance	■■■■■
Features	■■■■■
Build quality	■■■■■
Value for money	■■■■■

Duplex printing

Printing large documents can really be a cumbersome task, especially if your establishment is on a big cost-cutting drive and you have to print on both sides of the sheets. The actual procedure is long drawn—print one sheet, take it out, reverse it, place it back into the feed tray and print on the opposite side.

A faster alternative would be to print out the even-numbered pages first on one side, and then invert the entire stack to print the odd-numbered pages. This requires relatively lesser attention and work from the user's perspective. However, in single-turn as well as stack-turn manual-duplexing, the process of switching the sheets around can cause the paper to crumple, leading to further problems such as paper misfeeds, and paper jams. To avoid this, printer manufacturers provide secondary duplexing units, such as the one shown below, which when attached to the main printer unit, completely automates the duplexing process. The duplexing attachment usually sits very conveniently at the back of the printer,



and doesn't require any separate calibration and driver installation. To actually begin printing on both sides, there are a couple of things that need to be enabled in the properties settings of the printer.

STEP 1 Go to Control Panel, right-click the printer driver and select Properties. Next, switch to the General tab and click on Printing Preferences.

STEP 2 In the new dialog box that pops up, click on the Features tab. Now, enable 'Two-sided Printing' and tick the box just below to enable



automatic duplexing. So now while printing on both sides, after completing one side, instead of dropping into the output tray, the sheet gets retracted automatically back into the printer to print on its other side. At this point, the only thing that you need to do is remind yourself not to pull the paper out!